

KGALAKE BEN MABOTJA

SOC Analyst | Cybersecurity Professional

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Dedicated Security Operations Center (SOC) Analyst with hands-on experience in threat detection, incident response, and security monitoring across **both on-premises and cloud environments**. Built a comprehensive home SOC with **Splunk SIEM + Suricata IDS/IPS** on FreeBSD, and deployed a **cloud SIEM using LogTide on AWS EC2** ingesting Windows Event Logs via webhook. Successfully simulated and detected real-world attacks including reconnaissance, brute force, privilege escalation, and persistence. Strong foundation in networking and security principles from Cisco certifications. Currently working in security operations monitoring and responding to threats.

CERTIFICATIONS

Cisco Networking Academy – Complete Track

Certificate	Key Topics
Networking Basics	OSI model, TCP/IP, subnetting, routing, switching, network security
Junior Cybersecurity Analyst	Threat landscape, defense strategies, security policies, incident response
Ethical Hacker	Penetration testing, exploitation, post-exploitation (offensive knowledge for defensive purposes)

 Three digital badges available via Cisco Credly

In Progress: CompTIA Security+ | CompTIA CySA+ | TryHackMe SOC Analyst pathways

EDUCATION

Matric Certificate | Semaneng Secondary School

Relevant self-study: Security Operations, Incident Response, SIEM, Cloud Security, Network Security, Operating Systems (Windows, Linux, FreeBSD)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Operations (SOC)

- SIEM: Splunk Enterprise, LogTide (Cloud)
- IDS/IPS: Suricata (314+ rules)
- Cloud Security: AWS EC2, Security Groups
- Windows Event Logging (50+ audit policies)
- Threat Detection & Incident Response
- MITRE ATT&CK Framework
- Sigma Detection Rules

Network Security

- Nmap, Wireshark, Netcat
- TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VLANs
- FreeBSD pf Firewall
- Network Hardening

Operating Systems

- Kali Linux (Advanced)
- Windows Server (Event Logging, Hardening)
- Ubuntu Server (Cloud)
- FreeBSD (Firewall)
- Docker / VirtualBox

Scripting & Automation

- Bash / Shell Scripting
- PowerShell (Log Forwarding)
- SQL (PostgreSQL, Detection Queries)
- Git & GitHub
- YAML (Sigma Rules, Config)

FEATURED PROJECTS

☁️ Cloud SOC: LogTide on AWS + Windows DC Detection

📄 github.com/kgalake-byte/soc-project/cloud-soc

Deployed a cloud-native SOC using **LogTide on AWS EC2** ingesting real Windows Event Logs via webhook:

Component	Implementation
SIEM (Cloud)	LogTide on AWS EC2 (Ubuntu 24.04, Docker, PostgreSQL)
Log Ingestion	Webhook transport (HTTPS) from Windows DC
Detection	350+ logs captured, full command chain extracted
Attack Simulation	Brute force, backdoor accounts, privilege escalation
Detection Rules	Sigma rules for account creation, priv esc, suspicious processes

Key Events: 4624 (Logon), 4625 (Failed Login), 4688 (Process Creation), 4720 (Account Created), 4726 (Account Deleted), 4732 (Privilege Escalation)

IOCs: Attacker IP (192.168.1.10), Backdoor Accounts (soc_backdoor, attack_evidence), Tools (Evil-WinRM, net.exe)

✅ **Result:** Full attack chain captured with exact commands, MITRE ATT&CK mapping documented

🏠 Local SOC: Windows Domain Controller Attack Detection

📄 github.com/kgalake-byte/soc-project

Built a complete on-premises SOC environment to simulate and detect real-world attacks:

Component	Implementation
SIEM	Splunk Enterprise with custom dashboards for real-time attack visualization
IDS/IPS	Suricata with 314+ rules on FreeBSD firewall
Log Forwarding	Splunk Universal Forwarder for Windows Event Logs
Windows Logging	50+ audit policies including PowerShell logging, process creation, and account management
Attack Simulation	Reconnaissance, WinRM brute force, privilege escalation, persistence (backdoor accounts)

Key Detection Events: Event 4625 (Failed Logins), Event 4720 (Account Creation), Event 4688 (Process Creation), Event 4624 (WinRM Login)

✅ **Result:** Successfully detected and responded to all attack vectors

PENETRATION TESTING EXPERIENCE

Penetration Testing Lab: Ubuntu Server & Windows 10

📄 GitHub: github.com/kgalake-byte/penetration-test-lab

Conducted complete penetration test from reconnaissance to reporting:

Phase	Actions
Reconnaissance	Discovered open ports (Ubuntu: 22,80; Windows: 135,139,445)
Exploitation	Gained SSH access to Ubuntu using default credentials
Privilege Escalation	Escalated to root via sudo misconfiguration
Post-Exploitation	Extracted password hashes, established persistence
Windows Assessment	Discovered weak SMB credentials (non-admin access)
Reporting	Delivered professional report with findings and remediation

Tools: Nmap, Gobuster, CrackMapExec, SSH, Responder

Results:

- ✅ Ubuntu Server: FULLY COMPROMISED (root access)
- 🔹 Windows 10: Partial compromise (non-admin credentials)

HANDS-ON LAB EXPERIENCE

Cisco Networking Academy – Ethical Hacker Labs

- Configured penetration testing virtual lab environments
- Performed information gathering and vulnerability scanning
- Conducted simulated social engineering attacks
- Exploited application-based vulnerabilities
- Practiced post-exploitation techniques and reporting

Virtual Home Lab

- Built isolated lab with Kali attacker, Windows DC, Ubuntu Server, and FreeBSD firewall
- Configured host-only and NAT networking for realistic simulations
- Deployed cloud SIEM (LogTide on AWS EC2) with webhook ingestion
- Documented complete attack chains for portfolio
- Maintained snapshots for repeatable testing

WORK EXPERIENCE

Control Room Operator | Triple S Security, Polokwane

October 2014 – Present

- Monitor alarm signals decoded by three different signal decoders
- Quickly assess the urgency of each alarm signal
- Dispatch armed response when necessary
- Advise clients on security situations and preventative measures

Key Transferable Skills: Rapid threat assessment, Calm under pressure, Clear communication, Incident response coordination

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Completed

- Cisco Ethical Hacker Certificate (70 hours)
- Cisco Basic Networking
- Junior Cybersecurity Analyst
- TryHackMe pathways
- Home SOC Project (Splunk, Suricata, Windows Event Logging)
- **Cloud SOC Project (LogTide on AWS, Webhook Ingestion, PostgreSQL)**

In Progress

- CompTIA Security+ certification
- CompTIA CySA+ certification
- Splunk Core Certified User
- Microsoft Azure AZ-900
- Additional TryHackMe rooms and CTFs

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: English, Sepedi (Excellent spoken and written)

Interests: Security Operations, Threat Detection, Incident Response, Cloud Security, SIEM configuration

Online Presence: GitHub, LinkedIn, Personal Website

REFERENCES

Triple S Security

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Current Role - Control Room Operations

Additional professional references available upon request.